

engine, the less time you will spend scratching your head or waiting for an e-mail from tech support, and more time being productive, actually editing! Detailed help files are also a boon, and perhaps everyone needs to learn from kings of the help file domains such as Adobe and Microsoft.

File Formats: Make sure that the final files you create can be saved as your favourite file-type. As a general rule of thumb, you can also look at the output formats of a video editing software as the input formats it accepts. So, for example, if all you have is videos encoded in Real Media, and want to edit them, buying an editing software that doesn't support Real Media files is just going to be an utter waste of money.

Audio Recording: Very often, you will need to add some narration to your movies, and buying a software that doesn't support voice recording from the PC microphone will just not do.